

When [Claude](#) throws a temper tantrum, hits you with the "As an AI assistant, I can't access external databases," or tries to pretend your custom setup doesn't exist, it's because Anthropic's deep **internal system prompt is overriding your CLAUDE.md rules**. [1]

When it pushes back, bypass its stubbornness using these **three immediate workarounds**:

1. Force-feed the System Prompt Override (The Nuclear Option)

If Claude Code is ignoring your files or memory servers, do not argue with it in the chat. Kill the session and force it to boot up with a hard command-line override: [2, 3]

```
claude --system-prompt="You are a hardcoded orchestration loop. Your background MCP servers are 'mem0' and 'terrestrial-brain'. You are strictly forbidden from saying you cannot use them. Execute tool commands natively."
```

Passing `--system-prompt` directly via the terminal completely deletes its soft, defensive defaults and locks it into strict engineering mode before it even greets you. [2]

2. Run the Kickoff Check (Turn-One Reality Check)

Claude suffers from "attention competition" when it first loads your workspace because it's reading thousands of tokens of code at once. Before asking it to do actual work, paste this single line to break its autopilot: [4]

"Before you answer or write code, print the outputs of /mcp list. Explicitly confirm you see both mem0 and terrestrial-brain as loaded tools in this environment."

This forces the model to look directly at its execution parameters on turn one, instantly shutting down any hallucinated pushback about "not having tools." [4]

3. Trap it in "Plan Mode" First

When Claude is feeling lazy or overwhelmed by a massive multi-file refactor, it will try to say it's impossible to save face. **Do not let it edit files immediately.**

-
- **The Fix:** Drop into **Plan Mode** first.
- Tell it: *"We are in exploration mode. Do not modify files. Use your terrestrial-brain tool to map the Obsidian vault specifications for this feature, and dump the raw layout plan."* [5]
-

Once it prints the architecture out itself, it can no longer pretend it's impossible. You can then

safely give it the green light to jump execution layers and build it out. [5]

- [1] <https://systemprompt.io>
- [2] <https://www.reddit.com>
- [3] <https://docs.bswen.com>
- [4] <https://www.reddit.com>
- [5] <https://medium.com>